

IBM STERLING B2B INTEGRATOR 6.1

Session 13 · Lecture · Bridge to Hands-On Lab

SB2BI Integration with IBM ITX

How Sterling B2B Integrator pairs with IBM Sterling Transformation Extender for heavyweight mapping

Lecture · From ITX to Sterling Map Editor · Hands-On Lab Follows: 837 → 835

What is IBM Sterling Transformation Extender (ITX)?

A quick refresher, since you already know this tool — we're about to map it onto Sterling B2B Integrator

- ITX is the current name for what this product line has also been called WebSphere Transformation Extender (WTX) — a separate, transaction-oriented data integration and translation application.
- It automates the transformation of high-volume, complex transactions without hard-coding, supporting EDI, XML, SWIFT, and HIPAA standards, plus real-time integration across applications, databases, and messaging middleware.
- Sterling B2B Integrator's product literature describes itself as having "integrated universal transformation capability of IBM WebSphere Transformation Extender with business process management features of Sterling B2B Integrator" — the two products are designed to be paired.
- IBM's Standards Processing Engine portfolio ("ITX Advanced") is the next evolution of this Universal Transformation strategy — modular, standards-based document processing spanning WTX, Sterling B2B Integrator, and XSLT translation maps.

A brief history: WebSphere Transformation Extender → ITX



Originally

WebSphere Transformation Extender (WTX) — the name many teams still use day to day



Current naming

IBM Sterling Transformation Extender (ITX) — same underlying product line, current IBM documentation and licensing use this name



Current release line

ITX 11.0.x is the current generation per IBM documentation



Watch the calendar

The 10.1.x release line reaches end of support April 30, 2026 — a relevant date if your organization is planning a purchase or upgrade

ITX / WTX basics — what's under the hood

How the product actually processes data

Component	What it does
Transformation engine	Performs the actual transformation and routing of data from source systems to target systems, in batch and real-time
Sources	Files, relational databases, Message-Oriented Middleware (MOM), packaged applications, or other external sources
Graphical map editor (Design Studio)	Where you build type trees and maps — visually connecting input fields to output fields
Industry packs	Pre-defined support for multiple document standards (EDI, HIPAA, SWIFT, etc.) so you're not building standards from scratch
Technology adapters	A range of adapters connecting ITX to the various source and target systems it needs to reach

WTX for Sterling B2B Integrator: what the integration adds

Combining SB2BI's business process management with ITX's universal transformation

Capability	Why it matters
Trading partner management	Reuses SB2BI's existing partner records instead of re-modeling partners inside ITX
Enveloping and de-enveloping / bulking and de-bulking	Handles EDI envelope structures and batch document splitting around the ITX map
Document management and archive	SB2BI's document tracking and archival wraps around ITX-processed documents
Automated acknowledgment generation	SB2BI generates functional acknowledgments for documents ITX transformed
Reporting	Standard SB2BI reporting covers ITX-mapped transactions alongside every other document type
Managed file transfer with Sterling File Gateway	ITX maps can sit inside a managed file transfer flow, not just a point-to-point translation

ITX in the broader IBM B2B portfolio

It doesn't work alone — here's what else it commonly sits alongside

- Global Mailbox — provides data storage replicated across geographically distributed locations, so mailbox-triggered application processing keeps working even if a data center becomes unreachable.
- Partner Engagement Manager (PEM) — a multi-enterprise B2B engagement portal for collaboration, monitoring, and visibility of activity flows between an organization and its partners.
- ITX Advanced / Standards Processing Engine — the modular, standards-based evolution of the Universal Transformation strategy, spanning WTX, Sterling B2B Integrator, and XSLT translation maps.
- Control Center — a centralized monitoring and management system for operations teams watching business activity across Sterling products and FTP servers.

The takeaway: ITX is one piece of a larger B2B stack — knowing where it sits helps you scope a real integration project correctly.

PART 4

From ITX to Sterling Map Editor

Same job, different tool — every concept you already know from ITX has a direct Sterling B2B Integrator equivalent.

Tooling and architecture, side by side

Map Editor and ITX solve the same problem — this is where the two approaches differ

ITX concept	Sterling Map Editor equivalent	What's different
ITX Design Studio — a separate, licensed install	Map Editor — a free download from inside Sterling B2B Integrator itself	No additional license; installed once on any machine that will build maps
Type tree from a COBOL copybook, DFDL, or XML schema	Type tree from an X12/EDIFACT/positional/XML/CSV standard, via the New Map Wizard	Same concept, built from Sterling B2B Integrator's own standards database
A map service invoked as a business-process step	The compiled map is named directly inside the envelope's Translation/Compliance Checking setup	No separate invoke step — translation happens as part of enveloping / de-enveloping
A design tool's Test perspective	Test Map, or SI Map Test	Same purpose — run sample input, inspect the output before deploying
Mapping notes kept ad hoc	GAP Analysis — a named, formal phase in Map Editor's own methodology	Same idea, made an explicit step you'll practice in the hands-on lab

The five operations, mechanism by mechanism

The same job, expressed in each tool's own vocabulary

Operation	ITX mechanism	Sterling Map Editor mechanism
Copy	A copy card or straight-through link in the map graph	Simple Link — drag the input field directly onto the output field
Reformat	A reformat or string function in the palette	Extended Rule — a short scripted statement
Compute	A compute card (sum, arithmetic, comparison)	Use Accumulator for running totals; Extended Rule for multi-field math
Default	A default value set on the target field	Use Constant Standard Rule
Lookup	A lookup / cross-reference table built into the map	Use Code or Use Select Standard Rule

Where ITX fits vs. Sterling Map Editor

Sterling Map Editor (native to SB2BI)

- Built into Sterling B2B Integrator itself — a companion Windows download, no separate license
- Purpose-built for EDI, positional, and XML mapping — the same map types you'll build in the hands-on lab
- What you'll build immediately after this lecture — a full 837 claim to 835 remittance flow
- Lighter weight: no extra runtime engine, no extra adapter to install or maintain

ITX (heavyweight, standards-based)

- A separate licensed product with its own Design Studio, runtime engine, and adapter
- Built for very high-volume, complex, standards-heavy transformations at extreme scale
- Worth the license and operational overhead when transformation complexity or volume outgrows what Map Editor comfortably handles
- Same underlying idea as Map Editor — just a heavier tool for a heavier job

TALKING POINT

"Every mapping tool you'll ever use — ITX, or Sterling Map Editor in the hands-on lab right after this — is doing exactly one of five things to a field: copy, reformat, compute, default, or lookup. Once you can name which of the five a field needs, configuring the map is just picking the right building block."

Myth vs. reality: common ITX misconceptions

Myth

- "ITX replaces Sterling B2B Integrator"
- "Once you have ITX, you stop using native Sterling mapping"
- "ITX is a plug-in inside the SB2BI Admin Console"
- "Any B2B Integrator license includes ITX"

Reality

- ITX handles transformation only — SB2BI still owns business process orchestration, partner management, and monitoring
- Teams typically use both: ITX for heavyweight standards-based maps, Map Editor for everything else
- ITX is a separate application with its own Design Studio client and runtime engine, integrated via the ITXA adapter
- ITX requires its own separate license and installation — it is not bundled

PART 5

Integration Architecture & Licensing

What it actually takes to stand ITX up alongside Sterling B2B Integrator, if your organization goes there.

What ITX integration actually requires

A multi-piece install, not a single download

Piece	Role
ITX Design Studio	The Eclipse-based client used to build type trees and maps — typically installed on a Windows or Linux workstation, separate from the SB2BI server
ITX runtime/engine	Executes compiled maps; current IBM documentation refers to this generation as "IBM Sterling Transformation Extender," at the 11.0.x release line
ITXA (ITX Adapter for SB2BI)	Formerly the "WTX adapter" — installed on every SB2BI node via a vendor-provided script (e.g. InstallWTXService.sh on Unix/Linux) so a business process can invoke an ITX map
Container Integration path	A newer, container-based alternative to the classic adapter install, for environments that prefer Docker/Podman-based deployment
WTX Map Service	The SB2BI-side service required for WTX/ITX maps to operate — available with WTX 8.4 or later, and requires a licensed installation of WTX to access

A question worth asking your IBM contact: does every node need it?

- IBM support documentation directly addresses this: "Do you need to install ITX with every node of Sterling Integrator?" — the answer depends on your cluster topology and which nodes actually execute business processes that invoke ITX maps.
- In a clustered SB2BI environment, plan the ITXA install alongside your node architecture, not as an afterthought per box.
- A JRE/JDK version and OS combination that's on IBM's compatibility matrix for both your ITX version and Sterling B2B Integrator 6.1 — check the Software Product Compatibility Reports site before provisioning any box.

Licensing and procurement considerations

What to plan for before ITX is installed anywhere

Consideration	Detail
Separate license	ITX requires a valid IBM entitlement/license separate from your Sterling B2B Integrator license
No self-serve trial	No evidence of a public self-serve trial download for ITX — provisioning it means a conversation with IBM or your organization's IBM account team
Procurement channel	IBM Passport Advantage, or your existing IBM account relationship
Compatibility check	Confirm JRE/JDK + OS combination against IBM's compatibility matrix for both ITX and SB2BI 6.1 before provisioning
Support lifecycle	Watch release lines — e.g. the 10.1.x line reaches end of support April 30, 2026; plan upgrades accordingly

Where to go for the real thing: IBM documentation

Bookmark these before you start a real procurement conversation

Resource	Covers
"Installing ITXA for Sterling B2B Integrator: summary" (ibm.com/docs)	Step-by-step ITXA adapter installation for a real environment
"Do you need to install ITX with every node of Sterling Integrator?" (ibm.com/support)	Clustered/multi-node topology guidance
"ITX Container Integration with Sterling B2B Integrator" (ibm.com/docs)	The container-based alternative to the classic adapter install
IBM Software Product Compatibility Reports	JRE/JDK and OS compatibility matrix for ITX + SB2BI 6.1

When to reach for which mapping tool

- ✓ A field needs a straightforward copy, reformat, compute, default, or lookup, inside a flow you already own → Sterling Map Editor.
- ✓ Transformation volume and standards complexity are extreme, and a dedicated tool + team will maintain the maps → ITX.
- ✓ You need enveloping/de-enveloping, document archive, or acknowledgment generation wrapped around the transformation → this is native Sterling B2B Integrator behavior either way.
- ✓ You're not sure yet → start with Sterling Map Editor; its ceiling is lower than ITX's, but its floor (cost, learning curve) is far easier to justify first.
- ✓ Either way, name the operation (copy/reformat/compute/default/lookup) before you configure anything — the tool is secondary to naming the job.

Key takeaways

- ITX (formerly WebSphere Transformation Extender / WTX) is a separate, separately-licensed transformation product designed to pair with Sterling B2B Integrator's business process management.
- The WTX-for-Sterling integration adds trading partner management, enveloping/de-enveloping, document archive, acknowledgment generation, reporting, and managed file transfer around the transformation.
- Every mapping tool — ITX or Sterling Map Editor — does exactly five things to a field: copy, reformat, compute, default, or lookup. Name the operation first.
- A real ITX integration needs Design Studio, the runtime engine, the ITXA adapter (or container path) on every relevant node, the WTX Map Service, and a separate IBM license via Passport Advantage.
- Choosing ITX vs. Sterling Map Editor is a cost/complexity trade-off, not a technical requirement — the flow you're about to build by hand runs entirely on Map Editor, with no ITX required anywhere.

Now: Hands-On Lab

HANDS-ON LAB

Building 837 → 835 in Sterling Map Editor

Everything from here is live, in Sterling B2B Integrator — Map Editor, not slides.

- Open the 837 to 835 End-to-End Sterling Map Editor Guide and start at The Business Scenario.
- The guide's How Sterling Map Editor Compares to ITX section is the same bridge you just saw, in more depth — refer back to it any time a Map Editor term looks unfamiliar.
- Exercises A through D walk you through both maps and both business-process wiring steps, field by field, with exact menu paths and expected results at every step.

Work at your own pace, and flag it immediately the moment a step doesn't match what you see on screen.